



How scarcity affects you and your clients?

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What do these people have in common?

	Financial worker at the beginning of the month with a line of clients out the door
	Mother in a low income Minnesota family with bills to pay
	Chronically food insecure man who does not know when his next meal will come



Plan for session

Scarcity



Bandwidth



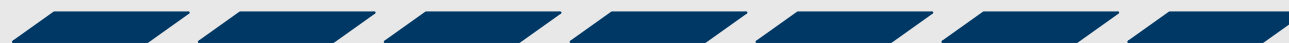
Tunnel



Poverty in context of scarcity



Behavioral science



Designing for scarcity





What do these people have in common?

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What do these people have in common?



Financial worker at the beginning of the month with a line of clients out the door

- Scarcity of time

Mother in a low income Minnesota family with bills to pay

- Scarcity of income

Chronically food insecure man who does not know when his next meal will come

- Scarcity of calories



Limited
bandwidth



Tunnel

What are situations in your life where you experience scarcity?



“I was just in a rush to get home...
because day care closes at 6. I get
off at 5... a 10-mile drive, busy
traffic... I had to pick up diapers...”

— *Brandi Drew*

Imagine you've got car trouble and repairs cost **\$300**.

Your auto insurance will cover half the cost.

You need to decide whether to go ahead and get the car fixed, or take a chance and hope that it lasts for a while longer.

How would you make this decision? Financially, would it be easy or hard?

[\(link\)](#)

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[\(link\)](#)



14

IQ point
drop for
people
with lower
incomes



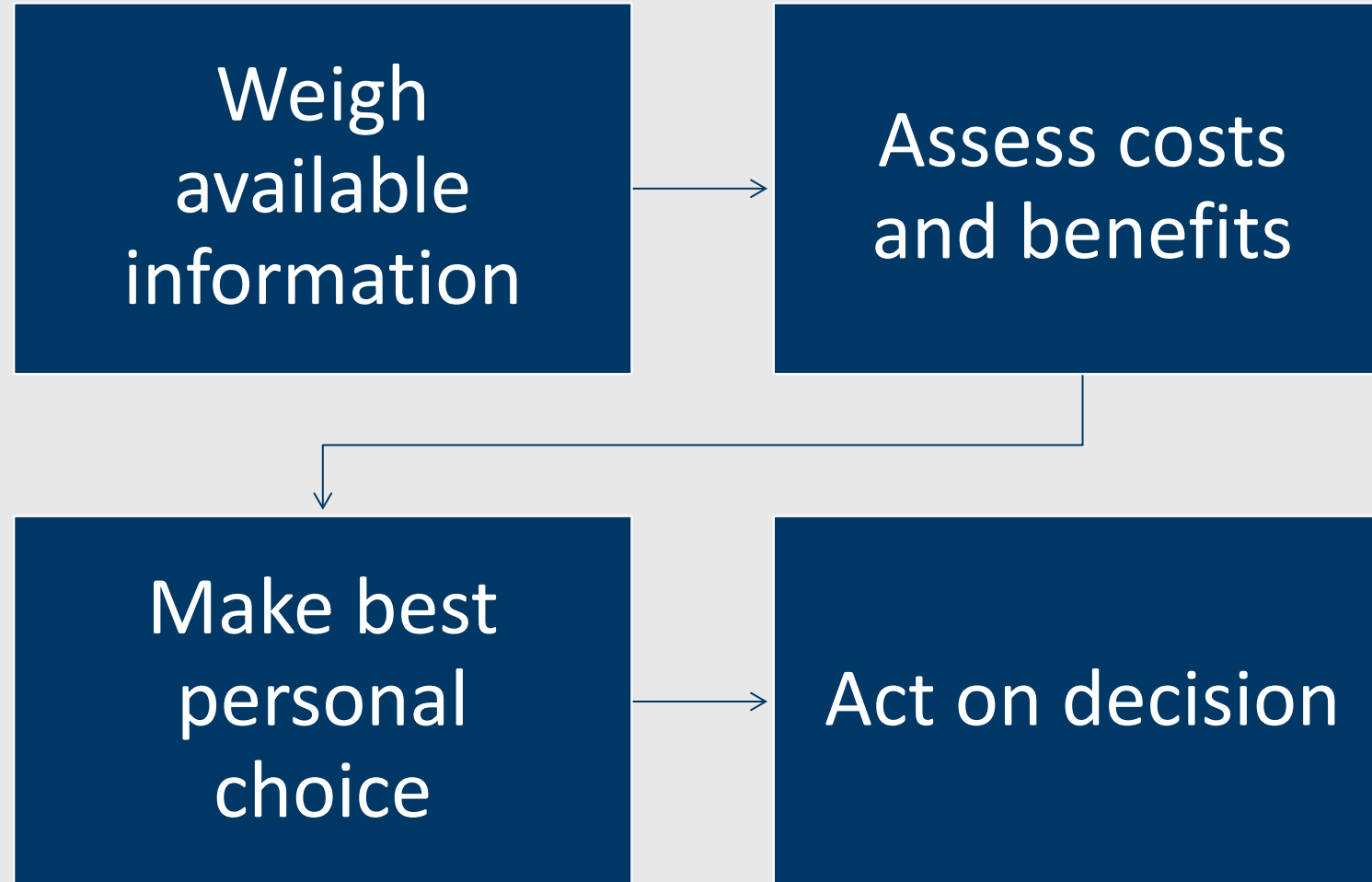
Poverty is chronic scarcity



Where do these lessons come
from?

Behavioral science

How do people take action? Traditional view



How do people take action? Behavioral view





Life gets in the way of rational
decision-making

Our systems exacerbate behavioral
barriers



Minnesota Department of **Human Services**

Combined Application Form

Apply online at www.applymn.dhs.mn.gov

Fail to
act...

This application can be used to apply for any of the following programs:

Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program (SNAP)

SNAP helps low income Minnesotans get the food they need for good nutrition and well-balanced meals. If you are age 60 and older and are applying for SNAP only, please use the "Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program (SNAP) Application for Seniors" (DHS-5223F).

Cash assistance programs

Cash assistance programs are provided to help families and individuals meet their basic needs until they can support themselves. Cash assistance programs include:

- Diversionary Work Program (DWP)

Hassle
Factors

How to fill out this application

IMPORTANT: If you are not able to complete this form, use the Blank Form to print the form and complete it.

Print Blank Form

Read all of the information in this application before you fill it out. If you need help filling out this application, ask someone for help. Complete and turn in your application by the deadline (page 8) as soon as possible to your agency. We can set your application on hold if you need more time. Your name, address and signature (page 1) must be included. We will have the complete application to decide if you qualify for help.

For your application to be complete, you must answer all questions and have certain information.

...due to
inconvenience

What are examples of
hassle factors in your
work?



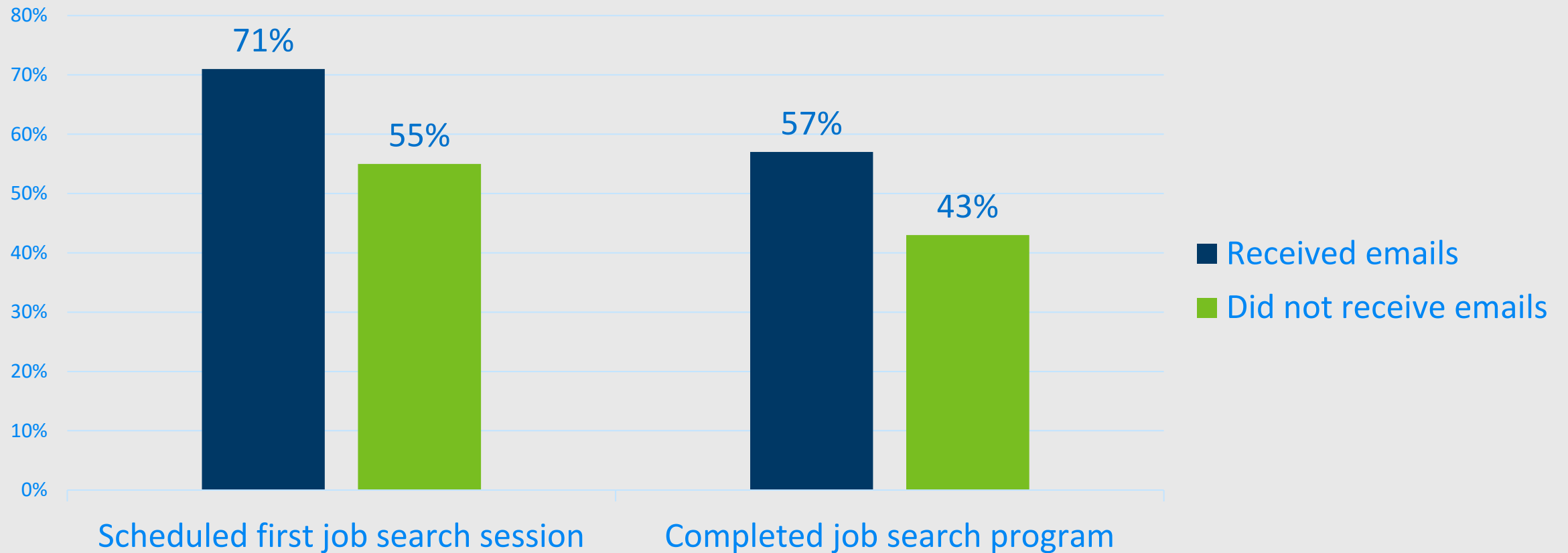
Cutting costs

Creating slack

Reframe and empower

Cutting costs: Michigan Works!

Response to email designed with lessons from behavioral science



Creating slack: Packing a car



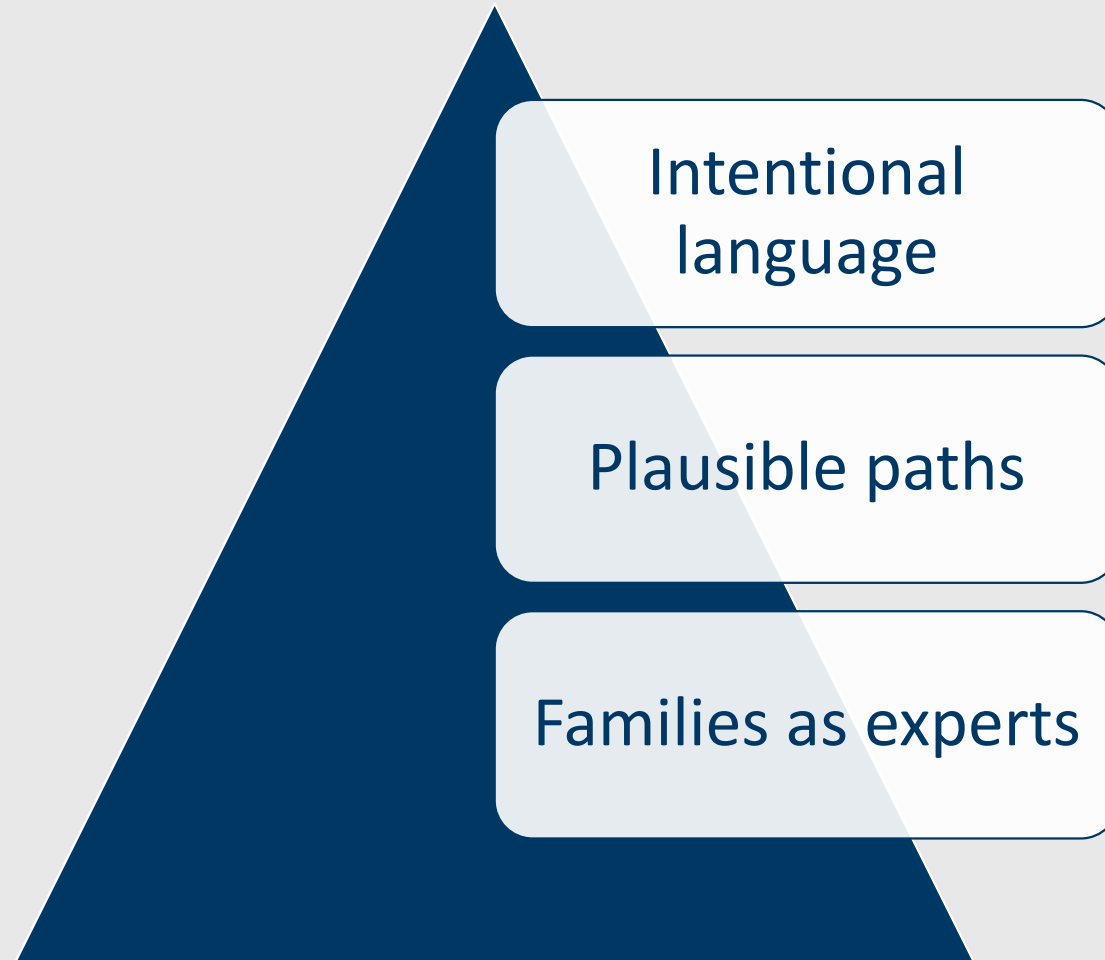
What costs do our systems put on you?

Are there opportunities to create more slack in your work?

How do your own experiences in scarcity affect your work with participants? [\(link\)](#)



Reframe and empower: Some ideas



How have you tried to
reframe your interactions
with families?

Scarcity

Behavioral
science

You



Thank you!

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